

GUIDE · PROCESS

Preparing for your *consultation*.

The first call is deliberately conversational. A short note on what to have at hand — and what not to worry about.

BY Derek Carrillo, Esq. FIRM Premier Estate Planning READING 4 minutes UPDATED Spring 2026

Our initial consultation is a thirty-minute, no-obligation conversation. Its purpose is to understand your situation and outline a path — not to collect paperwork. A little preparation makes it more useful, but perfection is not required.

Helpful to have at hand

- A rough picture of your assets and roughly how each is titled — homes, accounts, business interests, vehicles.
- The people you might name: a successor trustee, a financial agent, a healthcare surrogate, and — if you have minor children — a guardian.
- Any estate documents you already have, even if they're old or out of state.
- The questions and concerns that prompted the call in the first place.

Worth thinking about beforehand

- Who do you trust to act for you if you couldn't act for yourself?
- Should assets pass to beneficiaries outright, or be held and protected over time?
- Are there blended-family, special-needs, or out-of-state considerations?
- Do you have a financial advisor or CPA you'd like us to coordinate with?

WHAT NOT TO BRING

You don't need account numbers, statements, appraisals, or decisions made. Ballpark figures are plenty for a first conversation. The goal is direction; the details come later.

What to expect

We'll listen first, explain the structures that fit your situation in plain language, and outline next steps. If it's a good fit, you'll leave the call with a clear scope and a flat fee in writing — and no pressure to decide on the spot.

SCHEDULE A CONSULTATION

The conversation begins with a *thirty-minute call*.

Complimentary and confidential. We discuss your circumstances, outline a path forward, and quote a single flat fee in writing — before any work begins.

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